

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Phase 1 – Brainstorming & Ideation

Problem Statement

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, especially for standard laptop orders. Laptop configuration can be overlooked or delayed, increasing user waiting time and creating manual overhead.

User Story

As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the Hardware team for configuration.

Proposed Idea

Use ServiceNow Flow Designer to automatically create a Catalog Task after the Standard Laptop service request is approved.

Expected Benefits

- Timely laptop configuration
- Reduced manual intervention
- Reduced potential errors
- Better allocation of IT resources
- Improved user experience

Phase 2 – Requirement Analysis

Business Requirements

- Standard Laptop requests must be available through Service Catalog.
- The request must go through the existing approval process.
- After approval, a configuration task must be generated automatically.
- The task must be assigned to the **Hardware** group.
- The task must clearly identify that the laptop needs configuration.

Flow Requirements

Item	Required Value
Flow name	Standard laptop task
Application	Global
Run as	System user
Trigger	Service Catalog
Action	Create Catalog Task
Request item	Requested Item Record
Short description	Laptop need to Configured
Description	Laptop need to Configured
Assignment group	Hardware
Approval	Approved

Functional Outcome

Once the Standard Laptop request is approved, a Catalog Task should appear under the Requested Item and be assigned to Hardware.

Phase 3 – Project Design Phase

High-Level Design

User

- Service Catalog
- Hardware
- Standard Laptop
- Order Now
- Service Request
- Approval
- Flow Designer
- Create Catalog Task
- Hardware Assignment
- Laptop Configuration

Flow Design

Trigger

Use the **Service Catalog** trigger.

Action

Use **Create Catalog Task**.

Data Mapping

- **Request item:** Requested Item Record
- **Short description:** Laptop need to Configured
- **Description:** Laptop need to Configured
- **Assignment group:** Hardware
- **Approval:** Approved

Service Catalog Design

The Standard Laptop catalog item is connected to the created flow through its Process engine configuration.

Result

The design ensures that approval becomes the condition for automatically generating the hardware configuration task.

Phase 4 – Project Planning Phase

Planned Activities

- Identify the manual procurement/configuration problem.
- Define the Standard Laptop user story and objective.
- Create the Flow Designer flow.
- Configure the Service Catalog item to use the flow.
- Submit a Standard Laptop request.
- Approve the request.
- Verify automatic Catalog Task creation.
- Verify Hardware assignment and task details.
- Document the implementation.
- Demonstrate the complete workflow.

Milestones

Milestone 1 – Flow

Create and activate the Standard laptop task flow.

Milestone 2 – Flow Assignment

Assign the flow to the Standard Laptop service catalog item.

Milestone 3 – Service Catalog

Place the Standard Laptop order, approve it, and verify the resulting Catalog Task.

Risks

- Flow not activated
- Flow not assigned to the catalog item
- Incorrect approval value
- Incorrect assignment group
- Incorrect task description

Mitigation

Validate each configuration field and test the complete request-to-task process.

Phase 5 – Project Development Phase

Milestone 1: Create the Flow

- i. Open ServiceNow.
- ii. Go to All and search for Flow Designer.
- iii. Open Flow Designer under Process Automation.
- iv. Select New → Flow.
- v. Set Flow Name to **Standard laptop task**.
- vi. Set Application to **Global**.
- vii. Select **System user** as Run user.
- viii. Submit.

Configure Trigger

- Select Add a trigger.
- Search for **Service Catalog**.
- Select the Service Catalog trigger.
- Click Done.

Configure Action

1. Select Add an action.
2. Search for **Create Catalog Task**.
3. Select Create Catalog Task.
4. Drag the **Requested Item Record** into Request item.
5. Confirm the table is populated as Catalog Task.
6. Set Short description to **Laptop need to Configured**.
7. Add Description with value **Laptop need to Configured**.
8. Set Assignment group to **Hardware**.
9. Set Approval to **Approved**.
10. Leave remaining fields at their defaults.
11. Click Done.
12. Save the flow.
13. Activate the flow.

Milestone 2: Assign the Flow

1. Open All → Maintain Items.
2. Search for **Standard Laptop**.
3. Open the Standard Laptop record.
4. Open Process engine.
5. Remove remaining automations if applicable.
6. Add the Flow.
7. Select **Standard Laptop Task**.
8. Save the record.

Development Result

The Standard Laptop catalog request is connected to the automation that creates the Hardware configuration task after approval.

Phase 6 – Project Testing Phase

Test Objective

Verify that an approved Standard Laptop request automatically produces the expected Catalog Task.

Core Test

- Open Service Catalog.
- Go to Hardware.
- Select Standard Laptop.
- Select Order Now.
- Open the request number.
- Open Approvers.
- Approve the request.
- Open the Requested Item.
- Open Catalog Tasks.
- Verify task details.

Expected Result

The Catalog Task should show:

- ❖ **Short description:** Laptop need to Configured
- ❖ **Description:** Laptop need to Configured
- ❖ **Assignment group:** Hardware
- ❖ **Approval:** Approved

Additional Tests

1. **Flow is inactive** → expected configuration problem.
2. **Flow is not assigned to Standard Laptop** → task should not be created through this automation.
3. **Request is not approved** → approved-only task creation should not occur.
4. **Incorrect assignment group** → task routing is incorrect and must be corrected.